

Discussion of Josephine's Paper

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Overview

- ▶ How does influencer culture impact consumer beliefs in the vitamin and supplement market?
- ▶ How does consumer behavior change when exposed to influencer marketing?
- ▶ How does firm strategy adapt to the presence and impact of influencers?

Key Contributions

- ▶ Use of experimental design to isolate the effect of influencer marketing on consumer demand.
- ▶ Policy implications of regulating influencer endorsements in the health supplement market.
- ▶ IV design leveraging exogenous variation in influencer reach via random experimental assignment.

Constructive Comments

- ▶ Consider exploring alternative IV strategies surrounding influencer reach, like using difference in how platform pushes something like TikTok Shop, which is a more covert form of advertising than traditional influencer posts.
- ▶ Further discussion on potential confounders in the experimental design, such as pre-existing consumer attitudes towards supplements, i.e. cohort effects surrounding health trends.
- ▶ Explore heterogeneity in consumer responses based on demographics or prior health behaviors.